

Sunday, 11 October 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON Overcast 15° 10°	BIRMINGHAM Overcast 14° 9°	MANCHESTER Light drizzle 14° 9°	GLASGOW Overcast 13° 9°
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01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1

A man has tragically died after a tiger attack at a wildlife park near Doncaster, leading to the attraction's immediate evacuation.

The incident happened on Saturday, and the park has confirmed it will remain closed for the entire weekend. Emergency services were called to the scene, but sadly, the man could not be saved.

TRAGEDY · UK
- 2

The head of the Metropolitan Police's volunteer force has been fired after an AI tool found deleted intimate images on his work phone.

Special Chief Officer James Deller was dismissed after the monitoring software detected the images. This raises serious questions about data security and conduct within the force.

POLICE · UK
- 3

The grandfather of Sara Sharif, the 10-year-old girl murdered in 2023, has been granted guardianship of her four siblings in Pakistan.

All five children have been living with their grandfather since Sara's death. This decision provides some clarity for the children's future following the tragic events.

JUSTICE · UK
- 4

Eight men have been arrested by Greater Manchester Police just days after being released from jail, highlighting concerns about reoffending.

Some of the men were apprehended for breaching criminal orders, while others were arrested on suspicion of robbery or domestic violence. Police are working to understand the circumstances.

CRIME · UK
- 5

A murder investigation has been launched in Stoke-on-Trent after a man died and another was seriously injured in an attack.

Four people have been arrested in connection with the incident involving two teenagers. Police are appealing for witnesses as they piece together what happened.

CRIME · UK

What's coming up

1 **Afrobeats sensation Ayra Starr is set to make history as the first African artist to headline an international NFL half-time show!**

The Nigerian star will be performing at a major NFL game, marking a significant moment for Afrobeats on a global stage. It's a huge achievement for the genre and Ayra Starr herself.

ON AIR – What a moment for African music! Are you excited to see Ayra Starr perform?

MUSIC · UPCOMING

2 **Frozen yoghurt, a huge craze in the 2000s and 2010s, is making a big comeback across the UK with new chains popping up!**

Once a staple, froyo is returning with a vengeance, but at prices up to £12 a tub. It's a nostalgic treat for many, now with a premium feel.

ON AIR – Are you a fan of frozen yoghurt? Do you think it's worth the price tag for a bit of nostalgia?

FOOD · NOW

3 **Liverpool's iconic Cavern Club, the birthplace of so much music history, has been sold to new owners after 35 years.**

John Lennon's sister, Julia Baird, was one of the previous owners and says it's being left "in good hands." It's a new chapter for the legendary venue.

ON AIR – The Cavern Club is such a landmark! What's your favourite memory or story associated with it?

MUSIC · NOW

4 **A powerful new play exploring men's mental health, inspired by the world of boxing, is set to open.**

The production delves into the challenges men face in discussing their mental health and the support they can find in each other. It promises to be a moving and important piece of theatre.

ON AIR – It's so important to talk about men's mental health. What positive stories have you heard about men supporting each other?

THEATRE · UPCOMING

5 **Actress Olivia Colman has spoken about the viral 'Wicker memes' that have flooded social media ahead of her latest film's release.**

Steamy jokes and memes have taken over social media, making her latest film a hot topic. It seems the internet has embraced her new role with a lot of humour!

ON AIR – Have you seen the 'Wicker memes' for Olivia Colman's new film? What's your take on a bit of internet fun?

FILM · UPCOMING

On the schedule

1 **Max Verstappen has secured pole position at the Singapore Grand Prix, beating both Ferraris in a thrilling qualifying session.**

The Red Bull driver put in a superb performance, ahead of Charles Leclerc and Lewis Hamilton. It sets up an exciting race tomorrow on the challenging street circuit.

ON AIR – Verstappen on pole, but with Leclerc and Hamilton right behind him, who do you think will take the chequered flag tomorrow?

F1 · INTERNATIONAL

2 **Northampton Saints outgunned Bath in an incredible 119-point thriller, making it the second highest-scoring game in English top-flight history!**

The Saints won a high-octane match at home, with a staggering 18 tries scored between the two teams. It was a truly unforgettable spectacle for rugby fans.

ON AIR – What an unbelievable game of rugby! Have you ever seen a match with so many points scored?

RUGBY · UK

3 **Edinburgh Rugby have soared to the top of the nascent United Rugby Championship table after a bonus-point victory over Zebre!**

Their win makes it three from three for Edinburgh, showing a fantastic start to their URC campaign. They're definitely a team to watch this season.

ON AIR – Edinburgh are flying high! Which Scottish team do you think will go furthest in the URC this year?

RUGBY · UK

4 **The Lionesses have secured a valuable first-leg lead against Greece in their Women's World Cup qualifying play-off, winning 3-1.**

England put in a strong performance away from home, giving them a good advantage heading into the second leg. It's a crucial step towards World Cup qualification.

ON AIR – A solid win for the Lionesses! Which player impressed you most in their victory over Greece?

FOOTBALL · UK

5 **Darkness Falls proved the stronger to narrowly beat Desert Castle in the prestigious Dewhurst Stakes at Newmarket.**

It was a thrilling finish to one of the biggest races for two-year-olds, with Darkness Falls showing great determination. A fantastic performance on a big day for racing.

ON AIR – What a close finish in the Dewhurst Stakes! Do you enjoy the excitement of horse racing?

RACING · UK

Quick hits

- 1 The surprising joy of 'watching a perfectly brewed cup of tea' settle is being recognised.**
Apparently, the mesmerising swirl of milk meeting hot tea, creating little clouds, offers a moment of unexpected calm in our busy lives. It's like a mini-meditation in a mug!
- 2 The humble 'forgotten item in the back of the fridge' is getting a new lease on life.**
Rather than despair, discovering that half-eaten jar of pickle or a lone satsuma is now being hailed as a 'culinary bonus' – a delightful surprise for a snack or an unexpected ingredient for dinner.
- 3 The unique satisfaction of 'successfully parallel parking on a busy street' is a quiet triumph for many.**
Drivers are finding a genuine sense of accomplishment and a little cheer when they nail that tricky spot, especially with onlookers. It's a small victory in the daily commute.
- 4 There's a growing appreciation for the 'distinctive sound of a local church bell' on a quiet morning.**
For many, it's a comforting echo of tradition and community, offering a gentle reminder of the slower pace of life, even in bustling towns.
- 5 The simple pleasure of 'wearing odd socks around the house' is gaining popularity as a small act of rebellion and comfort.**
It seems a lot of us are embracing the mismatched look at home, finding a quiet joy in not conforming, even if it's just for our feet.
- 6 The art of 'choosing the perfect biscuit to dunk in your tea' is being elevated to a serious skill.**
Experts are weighing in on the ideal biscuit-to-tea ratio, the perfect dunking time, and which biscuits stand up best to the challenge without dissolving. It's a national pastime, after all!
- 7 The quiet thrill of 'being the first to spot a robin in winter' is a cherished moment for nature lovers.**
This small red-breasted bird, often seen as a sign of good luck, brings a little spark of joy and a connection to the natural world during the colder months.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to having a particular 'odd routine' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, new cup of coffee, especially if it's a special blend. What is it?

ANSWER: WAFING THE STEAM TOWARDS THEIR NOSE FOR A GOOD, DEEP SNIFF OF THE AROMA, EVEN IF THEY'VE SMELLED IT A HUNDRED TIMES BEFORE.

Q Our survey said that over 65% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when trying to quickly judge if a new brand of crisps will be good, even if we know it's not strictly scientific? What is it?

ANSWER: GIVING THE PACKET A GENTLE 'SHAKE AND LISTEN' TO HEAR THE CRISP-TO-AIR RATIO AND IMAGINE THE CRUNCH.

TALK TOPIC

- You know how sometimes you have a 'favourite shortcut or a slightly unusual route' you take when walking or driving, that just feels like your own little secret?

Perhaps it avoids traffic, takes you past something lovely, or just feels more adventurous. What's your secret path, and why do you love it so much?

- We all have that 'one particular household chore' that, oddly, we actually find quite satisfying or even relaxing to do, don't we?

It might be ironing, washing up, or tidying a specific drawer. Which chore is your unexpected favourite, and why does it bring you a strange sense of calm?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **History.** During World War II, the British government considered using glow-in-the-dark cats to help people navigate during blackout conditions.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** The first public park in the world was created in the centre of London, specifically designed for workers to enjoy nature during their lunch breaks.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£32 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£32 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The British Isles are home to over 1,500 different types of spiders, but only about 12 of them are capable of biting humans.
- The world's smallest fish, *Paedocypris progenetica*, is native to the peat swamps of Sumatra and can fit on the tip of a finger.
- The first ever recorded traffic light was installed in London, near the Houses of Parliament, in 1868.
- A group of unicorns is sometimes called a 'blessing', according to medieval bestiaries.
- The world's longest golf hole is the 7th at the Satsuki Golf Club in Sano, Japan, measuring 964 yards.
- The 'Penny Black' was the world's first adhesive postage stamp, issued in the United Kingdom on 1 May 1840.
- The average cloud weighs around 550 tons, roughly the same as 100 elephants.
- Crayola once made a glow-in-the-dark crayon that was technically edible, though not recommended for consumption.

On this day

Day 284 of the year, 81 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast days: Agilbert; Christian feast days: Alexander Sauli; Christian feast days: Andronicus, Probus, and Tarachus (Roman Catholic Church); Christian feast days: Æthelburh of Barking. Star sign Libra, birthstone Opal.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1978 — Trevor Donovan, American actor
- 1970 — MC Lyte, American rapper, DJ, and actress
- 1960 — Nicola Bryant, English actress
- 1992 — Christian Davis, English cricketer
- 1953 — David Morse, American actor, director, producer, and screenwriter
- 1992 — Cardi B, American rapper
- 1965 — Sean Patrick Flanery, American actor and producer
- 1965 — Lennie James, English actor

THE DAY TODAY

- 1937 — The Duke and Duchess of Windsor tour Nazi Germany for 12 days and meet Adolf Hitler on 22 October.
- 1958 — NASA launches Pioneer 1, its first space probe, although it fails to achieve a stable orbit.
- 2013 — A migrant boat sinks in the Channel of Sicily, with at least 359 people drowning.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1142 — A peace treaty ends the Jin–Song wars.
- 1999 — Air Botswana pilot Chris Phatswe steals an ATR 42 from Sir Seretse Khama International Airport and later crashes it into two other aircraft at the airport, killing himself.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 2000 — NASA launches STS-92, the 100th Space Shuttle mission.
- 1950 — CBS's field-sequential color system for television is the first to be licensed for broadcast by the U.S. Federal Communications Commission.

- 1987 — Start of Operation Pawan by Indian forces in Sri Lanka. Thousands of civilians, insurgents, soldiers die.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 285 of the year, 80 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Domnina of Anazarbus; Christian feast day: Edith Cavell and Elizabeth Fry (Church of England); Christian feast day: Fiacc; Christian feast day: Our Lady of the Pillar (Fiestas del Pilar). Star sign Libra, birthstone Opal.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1929 — Nappy Brown, American R&B singer-songwriter (died 2008)
- 1981 — Brian J. Smith, American actor
- 1935 — Don Howe, English footballer and manager (died 2015)
- 1990 — Henri Lansbury, English footballer
- 1974 — Stephen Lee, English snooker player
- 1992 — Josh Hutcherson, American actor and producer
- 1962 — Deborah Foreman, American actress and photographer
- 1942 — Melvin Franklin, American soul bass singer (died 1995)

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 2000 — Two Israeli reservists are lynched by a Palestinian mob at the police station of Ramallah.
- 2005 — The second Chinese human spaceflight, Shenzhou 6, is launched, carrying two cosmonauts in orbit for five days.
- 1992 — A 5.8 earthquake occurred in Cairo, Egypt. At least 510 died.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 2005 — The second Chinese human spaceflight, Shenzhou 6, is launched, carrying two cosmonauts in orbit for five days.
- 2019 — Eliud Kipchoge from Kenya becomes the first person to run a marathon in less than two hours with a time of 1:59:40 in Vienna.

10 — FORWARD PLANNING • FILM

Coming to cinemas

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 16 Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller

FRI 23 Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

On the sporting calendar